



Eduvos
Your Education. Your Future.



Wellness Guide:

eduvos.com

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SADAG: Mental Health Services



FREE TELEPHONIC STUDENT COUNSELLING

24 HOUR EDUVOS HELPLINE
0800 008 206

WHATSAPP +27 87 163 2050 (8 AM - 5 PM)

@THESADAG @THESADAG @SADAG_OFFICIAL

WWW.SADAG.ORG

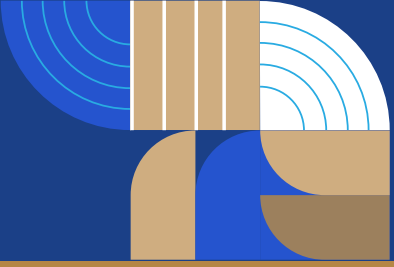
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Introduction



.Many students in higher education struggle with mental health and overall well-being, and Eduvos students are no exception. According to recent studies, approximately 1 in 3 university students globally experience symptoms of depression and anxiety, with mental health issues significantly impacting academic performance and personal development

At Eduvos, creating a supportive environment that prioritizes mental health is a key focus. This guide has been developed to help staff members better understand and respond to student well-being concerns. While some staff may already have experience dealing with such issues, others might feel uncertain or lack the necessary skills to effectively support students facing mental health challenges. This guide serves as a practical resource to bridge that gap, offering guidance and tools to assist in addressing students' mental health needs.

This resource has been thoughtfully prepared by the Wellness Team (Wellness Educators) at Eduvos to support staff in their interactions with students. The team adopts a holistic approach to student well-being, working in partnership with organizations like the South African Depression and Anxiety Group (SADAG) to provide comprehensive mental health support. Through these collaborations, Eduvos aims to create an environment where students can easily access the help they need whenever challenges arise.



Defining Mental Health

"A state of well-being in which the individual realises his or her own abilities, can cope with the normal stresses of life, can work productively and fruitfully, and is able to make a contribution to his or her community" (WHO, 2024).

Broadly defined because no 2 mental health challenges are the same

The impact of each mental health challenge is experienced and managed differently by each person



Example of good health



- **Positive self-esteem:** A student with good mental health may have a positive self-image, feel confident in their abilities, and have a strong sense of self-worth.
- **Effective stress management:** They can cope with academic pressure and other stressors in a healthy ways.
- **Healthy relationships:** They maintain positive and supportive relationships with peers, teachers, and family members, and can communicate their needs and boundaries effectively.
- **Balanced lifestyle:** They prioritize self-care activities such as exercise, healthy eating, sufficient sleep, and engaging in hobbies or activities they enjoy.
- **Resilience:** They demonstrate resilience in the face of challenges and setbacks



Example of ill-health

Is the absence of some or all these positive factors on an ongoing basis it is a range of Psychological disorders that affect an individual's daily functioning, e.g.:	
Isolation	the student withdraws from social interactions, avoids friends , does not participate in class , and becomes increasingly isolated.
Changes in behaviour	The student exhibits significant changes in behavior, such as sudden mood swings, irritability, or aggression.
Decline in academic performance	the student's grades drop, they have difficulty concentrating, completing assignments, or attending classes regularly.
Substance abuse	The student engages in excessive drinking, drug use, or other risky behaviors to cope with their emotions.
Lack of self-care	The student neglects basic self-care routines such as personal hygiene, eating regularly, or getting enough sleep.
Suicidal thoughts or self-harm	the student expresses thoughts of self-harm or suicide, engages in self-injurious behaviors, or talks about feeling hopeless and helpless.
Anxiety and panic attacks	The student experiences frequent anxiety attacks, panic episodes, or overwhelming feelings of fear and worry.
Difficulty coping	The student struggles to cope with everyday stressors, feels overwhelmed by academic pressures, and lacks effective coping mechanisms.



Example of mental ill-health

Is the absence of some or all these positive factors on an ongoing basis it is a range of Psychological disorders that affect an individual's daily functioning; Focus on culture	
Cultural stigma	The student may avoid seeking help for mental health issues due to cultural beliefs that discourage talking about emotions or seeking professional help.
Cculture shock	International or minority students may experience acculturation stress, feeling overwhelmed by the challenges of adapting to a new culture, language, and academic environment.
Cultural identity conflict	Students who feel conflicted about their cultural identity may experience internal struggles, isolation, and a sense of not belonging, which can impact their mental health.
Lack of culturally competent support	Students may struggle to find mental health resources that are sensitive to their cultural backgrounds and may feel misunderstood or marginalized in seeking help.
Religious or spiritual beliefs	Students may experience mental health issues that intersect with their religious or spiritual beliefs, such as feeling conflicted about seeking help outside of their faith community.



Risk factors

INSIDE THE LEARNING/CAMPUS ENVIRONMENT	OUTSIDE THE LEARNING/CAMPUS ENVIRONMENT
Poor communication - students not knowing what is expected in the learning environment and not feeling supported.	Unbalanced lifestyle or poor lifestyle choices, for example, alcohol or drug use which can put individuals at risk of developing mental health problems.
Limited class participation due to online learning	Family history of mental ill health which may be hereditary.
Inflexible working/study hours which do not support students in managing work/life balance.	Problems at home such as domestic violence, neglect, divorce, or family breakdown
Unclear assignments or objectives so students do not know what they need to do.	Feeling cut off from family and friends or from the local community which can lead to feelings of isolation or rejection
High or unrelenting workloads or study requirements which mean students do not have time to complete tasks.	Vulnerability such as low self-esteem and insecurity or inadequate coping mechanisms.
Unfair distribution of group work where one student is not doing their job properly and others must compensate for them.	Negative or traumatic life experiences such as relationship difficulties bereavement, sudden physical illness, or being assaulted or abused.
Poor adjustment to campus life due to cultural differences, language barriers and no immediate social support	Community problems such as prejudice and discrimination, violence and crime or poor living conditions.
Bullying and psychological harassment.	Financial worries!





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Different types Of Mental ill-health



Self-harm

- Any type of behaviour that does or could cause harm to the individual
- It can include physical harm such as cutting or burning the skin, picking at the skin, pulling out hair or breaking bones
- It may also include behaviours such as drinking, taking risks, such as driving fast, having unprotected sex, gambling and causing fights.
- Usually, the harm is used to relieve distressing feelings and help the individual to cope with difficulties in their lives.
- The self-harm gives temporary relief from negative thoughts and feelings and, in the long-term, may become a normal coping strategy for the individual.



Suicide

- Suicide is where an individual intentionally causes their own death.
- It may be because of factors such as mental ill health, traumatic or stressful events, physical illness, substance misuse or poor living environment.
- Quite often it will be due to a combination of factors.
- If someone can be prevented from initiating acts towards suicide, they can often be supported to move away from suicidal thoughts and recover.



Psychosis

- A mental disorder characterised by a disconnection from reality.
- Psychosis may occur because of a psychiatric illness such as schizophrenia or *ukuthwasa* (spiritual calling).
- In other instances, it may be caused by a health condition, medication or drug use.
- Possible symptoms include delusions, hallucinations, talking incoherently (reasoning does not follow a logical order) and agitation
- The person with the condition usually is not aware of his or her behaviour.
- Treatment may include medication and psychotherapy.
- Individual can be violent (in rear occasions)

Example of incoherent speech: "I went to the lecture today; the dancing was where all the problems came in. If it wasn't for that sour grapefruit this morning, my soccer game would be perfect."

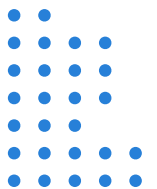


Anxiety disorders



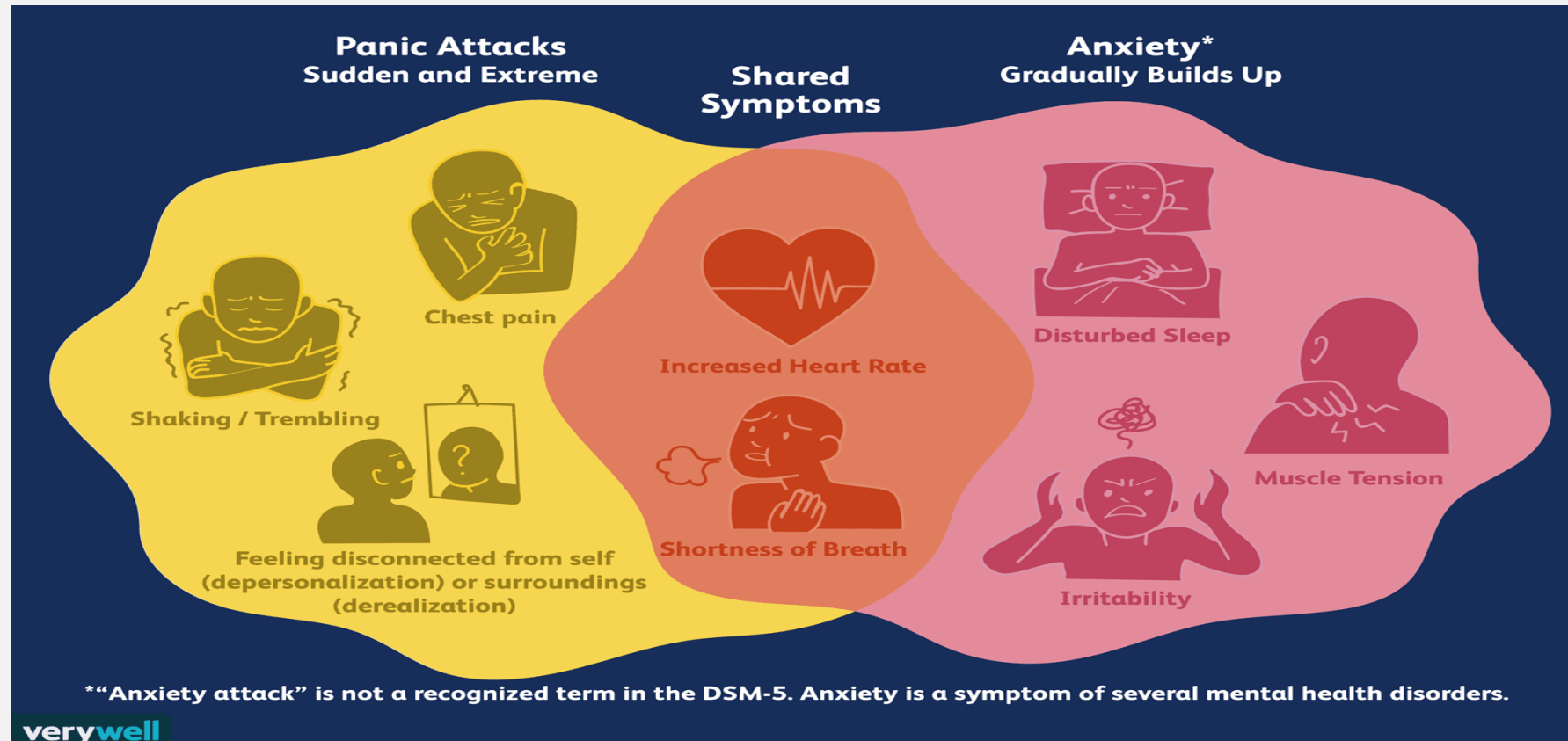
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NINKATEC Right at home			KNOW THE DIFFERENCES	
			NORMAL ANXIETY	VS. ANXIETY DISORDER
CAUSE	Triggered by a specific realistic problem			Does not have a specific cause or reason
SYMPTOMS & TREATMENT	Goes away when the stressor is removed. No need for treatment.			Intense, out-of-proportion & out-of-control. Need medical treatment.
DURATION	Happens for a short period of time			Lasts for 6 months or longer
EXAMPLE	Feeling nervous before a big presentation			Constant fear of doing or saying the wrong thing



Panic Attack

- Sudden onset of intense fear or discomfort that reaches a peak within minutes
- Can be brought on by a specific trigger or occur unexpectedly
- During panic attack individual can experience a combination of physical and psychological symptoms such as, rapid heart rate, sweating, trembling or shaking, impending fear/doom, etc.

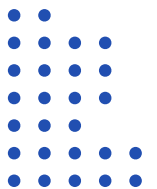


Substance Abuse:

- Use of substances such as alcohol, prescription medication, or illicit drugs, despite negative consequences, including physical, mental or social harm.



Substance	Description
Alcohol	<u>Alcohol Use Disorder</u> (AUD) refers to excessive and problematic drinking patterns that cause physical and psychological dependence.
Cannabis	Cannabis Use Disorder involves the excessive and problematic use of marijuana or hashish, leading to addiction and negative consequences.
Hallucinogens	Hallucinogen Use Disorder is characterized by persistent hallucinogen use despite negative consequences. Examples: mescaline, LSD, psilocybin, and DMT
Inhalants	Inhalant Use Disorder encompasses the misuse of volatile substances like solvents, aerosols, and gases, which are sniffed or inhaled to produce mind-altering effects. Examples: petroleum products (gasoline and kerosene), toluene (used in paint thinner, permanent markers, contact cement and model glue), and acetone (used in nail polish remover).
Opioids	Opioid Use Disorder involves dependence on both prescription opioids and illicit drugs like heroin. It is associated with a high risk of addiction and adverse health consequences. Examples: morphine, heroin, codeine, oxycodone, hydrocodone and fentanyl
Sedatives, Hypnotics, or Anxiolytics	This class includes medications such as benzodiazepines (e.g., Xanax, Valium), which can lead to sedative use disorder characterized by misuse and dependence.
Stimulants	Stimulant Use Disorder encompasses the misuse of substances like amphetamines, cocaine, and prescription stimulants (e.g., Adderall) that enhance alertness and energy. Examples: caffeine, nicotine, amphetamines and cocaine.
Tobacco	Tobacco Use Disorder refers to dependence on and addiction to nicotine, commonly found in cigarettes, cigars, and chewing tobacco.



Neurodevelopmental disorders:

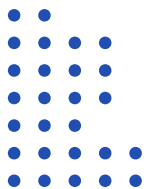
Autism spectrum disorder (ASD)

ASD is characterised by deficits in 2 main areas:

1. Challenges associated with social interaction and social communication across various contexts

Some challenges in this area, although not exhaustive:

- difficulty with back-and-forth conversation
- difficulty in knowing how to respond in various social contexts
- reduced sharing of interests, emotion and/or affect
- failure to initiate or respond in conversation
- difficulty in the area of non-verbal communication (inappropriate/lacking eye contact, body language, use of gestures)
- difficulties in developing, maintaining and understanding relationships



Autism spectrum disorder (ASD)

2. Restricted, repetitive patterns of behavior, interests, or activities

Some challenges in this area, although not exhaustive:

- stereotyped or repetitive motor movements, use of objects, or speech
- like things to be the same and struggle significantly with the smallest change and transitions (eg.
 - a cancelled class or venue change could cause great distress)
- rigid thinking patterns
- fixated on specific interests and focus on them intensely
- Sensory sensitivity (over-reaction or under-reaction to sensory input like noise or touch)
- unusual interest in certain sensory input from the environment (eg. visual fascination with light movement)

One important aspect to consider with ASD is the involvement of anxiety and anxious behaviours. Although not stated in the diagnosis, individuals with ASD often present with anxiety.



Attention-deficit/ hyperactivity disorder (ADHD)



Attention-deficit/ hyperactivity disorder (ADHD)

Neff, M. A. (2023). *ADHD overview: Signs of impulsivity/hyperactivity*.
Neurodivergentinsights.com. <https://neurodivergentinsights.com/blog/dsm-5-criteria-for-adhd-explained-in-pictures>

Neurodivergent
insights
Dr. Neff

ADHD Overview

SIGNS OF IMPULSIVITY/HYPERACTIVITY

		
Excessive talking	Fidgeting	Difficulty sitting still
		
Difficulty with quiet	Difficulty engaging in leisure activities	Difficulty resting
		
Intruding/interrupting others	Restlessness (can be internal)	Difficulty waiting turn/impatience

For a diagnosis, 6 of the 9 traits of impulsivity/hyperactivity must be present. Or 5 out of 9 for adults (but must be able to demonstrate traits were present before age 12).



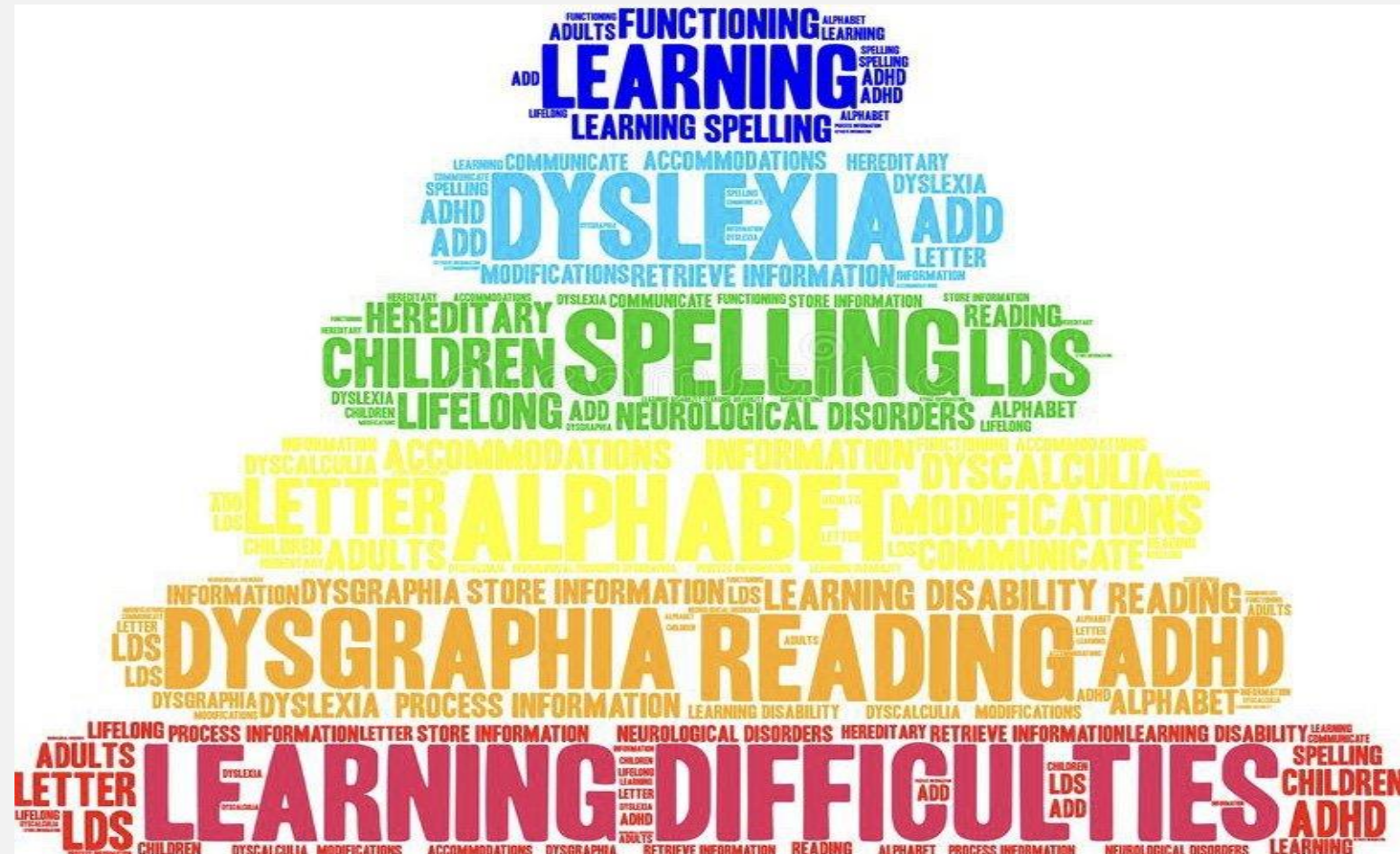
Specific learning disorder (SLD)

SLD is often diagnosed when the child is still at school but can sometimes go unnoticed until adulthood.

These individuals have a significant impairment in one or more of the following areas:

1. Reading
2. Written expression
3. Mathematics

Individuals who have educational learning needs will often need additional assistance during exam and test times. This could be extra time, a reader or scribe, or other concessions.



Traumatic experiences

Theft
Sexual assault
Mugging

Symptoms of Trauma

 SANDSTONE CARE



Physical

- Chronic Pain
- Fatigue
- Being Easily Startled



Emotional

- Feelings of Shame & Guilt
- Agitation
- Edginess
- Trouble Regulating Emotions



Psychological

- Anxiety Disorders
- Depression
- Nightmares





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Action plan

Mental health action plan

The MHFA Action Plan (ALGEE) is a step-by-step action plan to use when providing support to someone who may be experiencing a distressing situation. It is designed to provide early assistance to reduce the initial distress caused by crisis events and to foster short-term adaptive coping and functioning. The steps are outlined in the diagram:



5 step action plan

A- Approach, Assist & Assess	• Approach the individual calmly and non-judgmentally. • Assess the situation and the individual's needs. • If they are willing to engage, you can begin assessing their at-risk level (including aspects such as their risk of harm to self/others, medical condition, etc.) as well as any related immediate needs and concerns.
L- Listen nonjudgmentally	• Actively listen the individual without passing judgement • Give your full attention and show empathy. • Accept & validate the individual's feelings and encourage them to express their thoughts and emotions. • That the conversation with "I noticed that"
G – Give reassurance & Information	• Reassure the individual that they are not alone, and that help is available. • Provide them with Mental Health resources, e.g. (Helplines, support groups, hospital, mental health professionals, etc.) • Offer to assist them in accessing these resources if needed.
E – Encourage appropriate professional help	• If the individual is in crisis or requires professional support, encourage them to seek professional help from a mental health professional, e.g. (counsellor, psychologist, hospital, medical care, etc.)
E -Encourage self-help	• Encourage the person to use self-help strategies and coping mechanisms. (Relaxation techniques, exercise, or mindfulness, etc.) • Encourage the individual to reach out to friends, family, or other support networks.



What to do if a student is having a panic attack

Step	Description
Stay Calm	It's important to stay calm yourself so that you can help the student feel safe and supported.
Create a Safe Environment	Find a quiet and safe space for the student to sit or lie down. Remove any potential triggers or sources of stress from the environment if possible.
Give Reassurance	Let the student know that they are safe, and they are not alone you are there to help them.
Use Grounding Techniques	Help the student focus on the present moment by asking them to describe their surroundings or engage in simple activities like counting objects in the room.
Respect Privacy	Respect the student's privacy and confidentiality. Keep the information shared during the panic attack confidential unless there is a risk to the student's safety.
Support	Once the panic subsides encourage the student to reach out to a mental health professional for further support (<i>provide them with contact details for SADAG</i>).



5 senses grounding technique

Technique	Description
Deep breathing	Guide the student through deep breathing exercises. Encourage them to take slow, deep breaths in through their nose and out through their mouth to help regulate their breathing
Grounding objects	Provide a student with a grounding object, such as a stress ball, something that they can focus on to help bring their attention back to the present moment and distract them from the panic attack.
Muscle Relaxation technique	Help the student relax their body and reduce tension by guiding them through muscle relaxation exercise. This involves tensing and then releasing each muscle in the body (from the toes and working up to the head)
Mindfulness technique	- This techniques helps the student to stay in the present and reduce panic. - Ask them to name five things they can see, four things they can touch, three things they can hear, two things they smell and one thing they can taste.
Visualization	- Ask the student to visualize a safe place in their minds - Ask the student to describe this place in detail.



WHAT TO DO IF A STUDENT IS SUICIDAL

Step	Description
Stay calm and listen	Approach the student in a calm and non-judgmental manner. Encourage them to talk about their feelings and listen attentively without interrupting.
Take their thoughts seriously	It's important not to dismiss or minimize their feelings. Let them know that you take their thoughts of suicide seriously and are there to help.
Assess the situation:	- Ask direct questions to assess the severity of the situation, such as whether they have a plan, access to means, or have attempted suicide before. This information can help you determine the level of risk. - Do not force them to give you information.
Do not leave the student alone:	Stay with the student and ensure that they are not left alone, especially if they are in immediate danger.
Contact	- If the student is in immediate danger or has a plan to harm themselves, contact emergency services(ambulance) or a crisis hotline for immediate assistance. - Contact their parents (even if they do not give consent).
Resources	Provide contact details for SADAG, for further mental health support

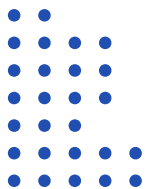


WHAT TO DO IF A STUDENT IS SELF-HARMING

Step	Description
Stay calm and non-judgmental	It's important to remain calm and composed when talking to the student. Avoid showing shock or disapproval, as this can make the student feel more isolated and hesitant to open up .
Listen actively	Give the student your full attention and listen to what they have to say without interrupting. Let them express their feelings and thoughts without judgment.
Express empathy and concern	- Let the student know that you care about their well-being and that you are there to support them. Express empathy for their feelings and let them know that they are not alone in dealing with their struggles.
Encourage professional help	- While you can provide initial support, it's important to encourage the student to seek help from a mental health professional. - Provide/assist them with SADAG contact details.(assist the student to schedule their appointment with SADAG)
Maintain confidentiality	Respect the student's privacy and maintain confidentiality about the situation, unless there is a risk of harm to themselves or others. Assure the student that you will only share information with appropriate individuals who can help them.
Take care of yourself	Supporting someone who is self-harming can be emotionally challenging. Make sure to take care of your own mental health , seek support from mental health professional if needed

Note:

Remember your role is to provide initial support and guidance to the student. If the situation is urgent or if the student is in immediate danger, don't hesitate to seek help from emergency services



WHAT TO DO If A STUDENT IS HAVING PSYCHOSIS

Steps	Description
Stay calm and composed:	• It is important to remain calm and composed when interacting with a student experiencing psychosis. Your demeanor can help reassure the student and prevent escalating the situation.
Ensure safety:	• Safety should be your top priority. Make sure that the student and those around them are safe from harm. If necessary, call for help from campus security or emergency services. •
Establish trust and rapport	• Approach the student in a non-threatening and non-judgmental manner. Use active listening skills to demonstrate empathy and understanding. • Respect cultural differences and be mindful of the student's cultural background.
Respect cultural beliefs and practices	• Be aware of cultural beliefs and practices that may influence the student's experience of mental health. Respect the student's cultural background and avoid making assumptions based on stereotypes.
Contact	• If contact emergency services (ambulance) • Contact parents/sponsor of the student



STUDENT DEALING WITH A TRAUMATIC EXPERIENCE

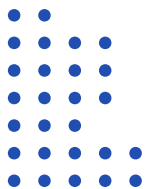
Steps	Description
.Ensure safety:	First and foremost, ensure the immediate physical safety of the student. If the incident just occurred, make sure the student is in a safe environment and away from any potential harm.
Provide a safe space	Offer a quiet and private space where the student can talk about their experience if they feel comfortable doing so. Respect their boundaries and let them know they can take their time.
Offer practical assistance:	Depending on the situation, you can offer practical assistance such as contacting campus security, counseling services, or local authorities if needed. Provide information on available resources for support.
Follow up:	Check in with the student regularly to see how they are doing and offer ongoing support. Let them know that you are there for them if they need to talk or seek help.
SADAG	For continuous counselling support.



SEXUAL ASSULT

Steps	Description
.Ensure safety:	First and foremost, ensure the immediate physical safety of the student. If the incident just occurred, make sure the student is in a safe environment and away from any potential harm.
Believe and validate	It is important to believe the student and validate their experience. Let them know that you believe them and that what happened was not their fault. Avoid judgment or blame.
Listen actively:	Encourage the student to share their feelings and experiences at their own pace. Practice active listening by being present, empathetic, and non-judgmental. Allow them to express themselves without interruption.
Offer support	Provide emotional support and reassurance to the survivor. Let them know that you are there to listen, support them, and help them access resources for further assistance, SADAG Counselling, Police number.
Respect their autonomy	Respect the student's decision and empower them to make their own decisions about seeking help or reporting the assault. Offer information on available resources, but let them choose the next step
Encourage professional help	Encourage the student to seek support from a trained counselor, therapist, Professional who deals with trauma and sexual assault(police officer) . Offer to help them find reach out and make appointment.
Be mindful of triggers:	Be mindful of potential triggers that may retraumatise the students . Avoid asking probing questions or pressuring them to share details they are not comfortable talking about.

Dealing with a student who has experienced sexual assault is a sensitive and complex situation that requires a trauma-informed approach. it is crucial to respond with care and compassion while prioritizing the well-being and safety of the student.



Confidential

Confidentiality is a crucial aspect of mental health first aid that ensures the privacy and trust of individuals seeking support. As a mental health first aider, it is essential to understand and uphold the principles of confidentiality to create a safe and supportive environment for those in need.

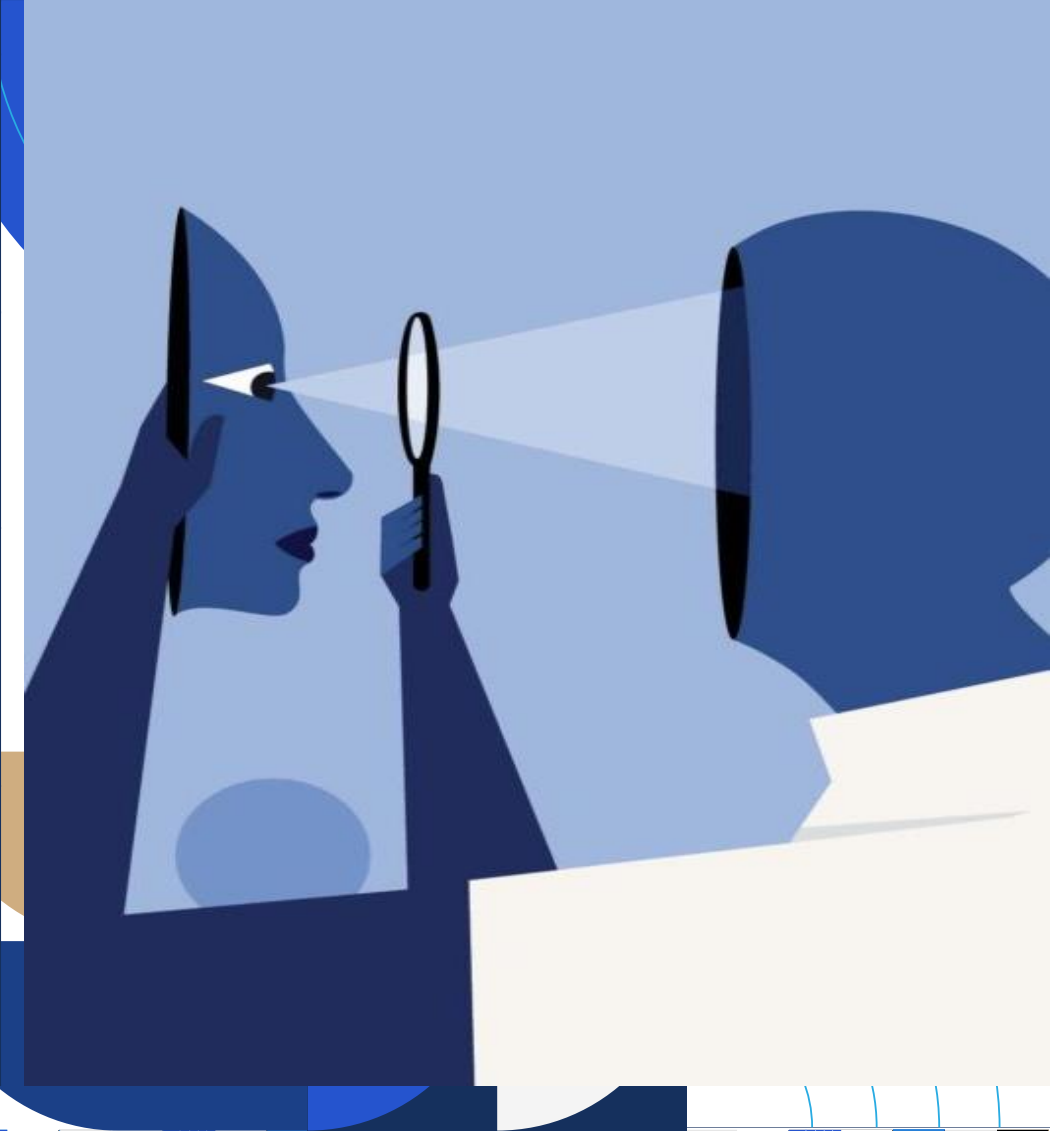




Confidentiality



KEY ASPECTS	
Trust and Safety	When individuals reach out for mental health support, they are often in a vulnerable state. Assuring them that their conversations will remain confidential builds trust and encourages them to open about their struggles without fear of judgment or repercussions.
Privacy & Respect	Respecting the privacy of individuals is a fundamental human right. By maintaining confidentiality, mental health first aiders demonstrate respect for the personal information shared with them.
Encouraging Help-seeking Behavior	Confidentiality promotes a culture of help-seeking by reducing the stigma associated with mental health issues. When individuals feel assured that their conversations will be kept confidential, they are more likely to reach out for support, knowing that their privacy will be respected.
Ethical Obligation	Upholding confidentiality is not only an ethical responsibility but also a legal obligation in many jurisdictions. Understanding the legal and ethical aspects of confidentiality ensures that mental health first aiders operate within the boundaries of professional conduct and uphold the rights of those seeking assistance.



Confidentiality limitations



CONFIDENTIALITY LIMITATIONS:

Imminent Risk of Harm	If a person expresses an intention to harm themselves or others, mental health first aiders may need to breach confidentiality to prevent harm. In such cases, it is important to take appropriate steps to ensure the safety of the individual and others.
Duty to Report	Mental health professionals, including mental health first aiders, have a duty to report certain issues, such as suspected abuse, or threats of violence, in accordance with legal and ethical guidelines.
Professional Consultation	In some situations, mental health first aiders may need to seek guidance from the wellness educators , or other appropriate resources to ensure that the individual receives the necessary support.

Referral Process

Students showing signs of mental ill health may need to be referred mental health professionals. The best scenario is where the student agrees to seek help. In this case you can refer them to SADAG or wellness educators





Keep the following in mind:

- The dignity and rights of every student are to be respected in every circumstance.
 - Ensure the student's right to privacy and confidentiality.
 - The best interest of the student is to be prioritised over any other consideration.
 - The use of stereotypes in referring should be avoided.
 - Students must be represented in a dignified, respectful manner.
 -
- 
- 



Emergency Referral



During an emergency referral, the best interest of the student might be to contact the sponsors without his/her consent, to get medical services or to overrule the student's wishes.

- The following signs indicate **emergency referral**:
- • You believe a student is showing signs of serious mental ill health such as psychosis but refuse to seek help for themselves.
- • If the student is likely to harm themselves or is suicidal.
- • If the student is doing something that could put other people at risk such as becoming violent or aggressive towards others





Emergency Referral



- **Action plan:**
- STEP 1: Contact the campus wellness educator(if available on campus) .
- STEP 2: Inform the Academic and Student Experience Manager (ASEM)/ Student Advisor(SAA). **(Start at Step 2 if the Wellness Educator is unavailable)**
- STEP 3: Contact the emergency response ambulance if the student is uncontrollable or injured.
- STEP 4: Contact the student's sponsors/parents
- STEP 5: Provide relevant medical contact numbers to the sponsors/parents.
- STEP 6: if a student requests individual counselling please refer to SADAG.

For immediate telephonic wellness counselling:24-hour Eduvos helpline: 0800008206
(Toll free)

SADAG :24-hour Eduvos Helpline: 0800008206

WhatsApp : +27871632050 (8am-5pm)

Scenario 1

You are talking to a student, who is explaining something to you. While the student is talking to you notice that there are markings on their wrist. These markings look like they could have been made recently.

What do you do in this situation?

Step 1: Ensure you are in a safe space to talk and speak with compassion and empathy

Step 2: **Talk to student and let them know you have seen the markings**

Step 3: Inform the student you will need to speak to the wellness lead about what you have seen – If they are concerned about sponsors, you can tell them that they can speak to the wellness lead about that

Step 4: Provide SADAG counselling details to the student and let them know they will be in touch

Step 5: Inform the wellness educator you have given the student the SADAG details

Step 6: If the wellness educator is not on campus, contact the ASEM/SAA

A student has come to you to ask how they can apply for a deferral. Upon further enquiry, you asked what the reason for the deferral is. The student then confided in you that they had been sexually assaulted 2 days ago. What is your next step and how would you talk to a student in this situation?

Scenario 2

How would you talk:

Compassion, empathy, non-judgement, not speaking in an accusatory tone, not asking detail about the incident, comforting tone of voice and neutral body language, reassurance and offer assistance

Step 1: Make sure you are in a confidential environment, go to a different space if necessary

Step 2: Inform them you will contact WE

Step 3: Give them SADAG info

Step 4: Ensure them you will support them in their academics and make sure they will get the help they need

If the Wellness educator is not there, contact the ASEM/SAA

You are approached by a student who is currently experiencing a panic attack. This student appears to be visibly distressed, is sweating, has rapid breathing and is trembling. The student can barely speak, but confides in you that they are feeling overwhelmed and stressed by academic deadlines and exams coming up. How would you assist this student?

Scenario 3

Step 1: Ensure you are in a quiet place with as little as possible people

Step 2: ask the student for their name and tell them your name, let them know they are safe with you and you will get them through this

Step 3: apply grounding technique

Step 4: Once the situation had subsided, inform them you will let the WE know what happened, for them to check in

Step 5: provide SADAG counselling details

A student who you are familiar with on campus comes to you one day looking distressed and heartsore. Their eyes are tearful, and they start explaining to you that they do not want to live anymore, and they are considering taking their own life. What are your next steps?

Scenario 4

Step 1: Inform them that you will need to tell the W on campus

If the wellness lead is not on campus/ Contact the ASEM/SAA

Step 2: Disclose that they will need to tell the sponsor

Step 3: Call the sponsor and tell them about the situation and ask about medical aid – If they are on medical aid or have seen a psychiatrist previously, they can be contacted and the psychiatrist can book them in

Step 3: Public – Call the ER and have them admitted



Emergency Referral



- **Action plan:**
- STEP 1: Contact the campus wellness educator(if available on campus) .
- STEP 2: Inform the Academic and Student Experience Manager (ASEM)/ Student Advisor(SAA). **(Start at Step 2 if the Wellness Educator is unavailable)**
- STEP 3: Contact the emergency response ambulance if the student is uncontrollable or injured.
- STEP 4: Contact the student's sponsors/parents
- STEP 5: Provide relevant medical contact numbers to the sponsors/parents.
- STEP 6: if a student requests individual counselling please refer to SADAG.

For immediate telephonic wellness counselling:24-hour Eduvos helpline: 0800008206
(Toll free)

SADAG :24-hour Eduvos Helpline: 0800008206

WhatsApp : +27871632050 (8am-5pm)



Mental Health is a Journey

Mental health... is not a destination, but a process. It's about how you drive, not where you're going." — Noam Shpancer, PhD